

The blog

Personal voice, invite interaction

WORD COUNT	REGISTER	TITLE	KEY FEATURE
~250 or ~400	Informal to semi-formal	Post: yes / Comment: no	Personal, invite comments

STRUCTURE AND LAYOUT

Username

Date / time

Title — post only — attention-grabbing

Introduction — ~50 words — hook the reader, introduce topic

Body paragraphs 1-3 — ~50-80 words each — one bullet point per paragraph

Conclusion — ~50 words — wrap up + invite readers to comment

DO'S AND DON'TS

DO

- Write in a personal, engaging voice
- Share personal experiences and opinions freely
- Address the reader directly ("you")
- Encourage readers to comment (blog post)
- Reference the original post in your opening (blog comment)
- Contractions are OK (don't, I'm, it's)
- Be original and show personality
- Shorter paragraphs work well here

DON'T

- Don't write like an essay (too formal)
- Don't forget to invite comments (blog post)
- Don't forget to reference the original post (blog comment)
- Don't be rude or offensive — remember it's public
- Don't use academic phrases like "It is widely believed that..."

WEAKER VS. STRONGER

WEAKER

"One should carefully consider the various advantages before deciding to take a gap year."

STRONGER

"I used to think a gap year was just an expensive way to put off real life. Then I took one, and it changed my mind."

Why it matters. Blogs work through a personal, informal voice with contractions and a short story. Formal phrasing like one should consider is essay register dropped into the wrong text type.

KEY TIP

Key tip. For a blog COMMENT, your very first sentence must reference the original post by name: "Hi Jeff, I stumbled across your blog on overtourism and it really made me think..."

USEFUL PHRASES

Blog post openers

- It took me ages to figure this out, but...
- So, here's what I've been thinking about...
- You won't believe what happened to me...
- OK so hear me out —

Blog comment openers

- Hi [name], I've just seen your blog on...
- I stumbled across your post and...
- This really resonated with me because...

Engaging the reader

- What do you think?
- I'd love to hear your thoughts on this.
- Let me know in the comments!
- Has anyone else experienced this?
- Am I the only one who...?

MODEL TEXT

Why I Quit Instagram for a Month (And What Happened Next) (~250 words · Informal)

by max_adventures · 22 March 2026, 19:34 Why I Quit Instagram for a Month (And What Happened Next)

OK so hear me out — I know everyone talks about digital detoxes these days, but I actually went through with it. Last month I deleted Instagram from my phone. Cold turkey. No "screen time limits", no "I'll just check once a day" — gone. And honestly? It was weird. My friends genuinely thought I had lost my mind. One of them actually asked if I was okay, as if deleting an app were some kind of cry for help.

The first few days were rough. I kept unlocking my phone and staring at the empty space where the app used to be. I realised I'd been scrolling for about two hours every single day. That's basically the same as watching a movie. Every. Day. But after about a week, something clicked. I started reading before bed again. By the end of the second week, I had finished an entire book, the first one in months, and somehow my brain felt quieter and less twitchy.

So, am I back on Instagram now? Yeah, I am. But I use it differently: maybe 20 minutes a day, max. The month off taught me it's just a tool, and I'd been treating it like a lifestyle. Have any of you tried something like this? I'd love to hear your stories in the comments! If you have ever felt like your phone owns you instead of the other way round, maybe give it a try. Worst case, you waste a weekend. Best case, you get a little piece of your life back.

More online. This text type also has a second model text on a different topic for you to analyse yourself, plus quizzes and a sentence-ordering exercise, at matura.bernhardgmeiner.com.